

Task 4: Foreign Non-Profits and Tax-Haven Owners

Descriptive Profiles, Outliers, and Case Studies

Disconnected Landlords Project

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Abstract

Descriptive deep-dive into two ownership groups flagged in the PI feedback: foreign-incorporated non-profit proprietors and tax-haven incorporated proprietors of privately rented housing in England and Wales. We characterise the universe (counts by local authority, jurisdiction of incorporation, and region), identify the largest proprietors and outlier properties, and develop a shortlist of case studies from public-register data. All named entities are registered companies from the public CCOD/OCOD registers; no individual beneficial owners are identified.

1 Data and definitions

Groups are defined exactly as the corresponding regression treatments (`treatment_definitions.R`):

- **Foreign non-profit** (`frnp`): proprietorship category Non-Profit/Community Organisations, incorporated outside the United Kingdom.
- **Tax-haven non-profit** (`thnp`): non-profit category, incorporated in an IMF-list tax-haven jurisdiction.
- **Tax haven, all** (`th`): any proprietor incorporated in a tax-haven jurisdiction, with sub-classes British (Crown dependencies and overseas territories), European, Caribbean, and other.

The reference group is the standard control: privately rented properties with unknown ownership (not in CCOD/OCOD). Properties are deduplicated by UPRN; title-to-UPRN expansion means title counts and property counts are reported separately. Produced by `scripts/08b_offshore_nonprofit`. outputs in `output/offshore_profiles/`.

2 Universe

Across England the register links 181,952 domestic properties to a tax-haven-incorporated or foreign-incorporated proprietor: 174,947 to a tax-haven company (group `th`), of which 10,777 sit under a foreign non-profit (`frnp`) and 3,772 under a tax-haven non-profit (`thnp`). The non-profit groups overlap the tax-haven group by construction (a Jersey housing society is both foreign and a tax haven), so the three counts are not additive.

The universe is overwhelmingly held through the British Crown Dependencies and Overseas Territories: 167,996 properties (92 percent) are incorporated in a “british” haven, led by Guernsey (76,691), Jersey (56,714), the British Virgin Islands (19,746) and the Isle of Man (11,790). This concentration is an artefact of who uses these jurisdictions: the Channel Islands are the home

of the large ground-rent freehold vehicles (see below), while the classic wealth-holding havens supply a much smaller but distinctive tail.

A clear efficiency gradient runs across jurisdictions. The Channel Islands freehold stock is efficient and new (Guernsey mean EPC 78, 11 percent below band C; Jersey 77, 14 percent), because these owners hold only the freehold reversion of modern leasehold flats. The opaque wealth havens hold older, far less efficient prime and period stock: the British Virgin Islands (mean 72, 28 percent below C), Isle of Man (72, 30 percent), Gibraltar (67, 49 percent), Panama (66, 48 percent) and the Seychelles (68, 43 percent). Aggregated by class, “british”-incorporated properties are 16 percent below band C against 40 percent for “caribbean” and 37 percent for “european” incorporations. The foreign non-profit tail is dominated by Luxembourg (5,384 properties, mean EPC 78), reflecting institutional student and build-to-rent vehicles rather than wealth holding.

Table 1: Tax-Haven Owned Rental Properties by Jurisdiction of Incorporation

Jurisdiction	Properties	Titles	Proprietors	Mean EPC	Share <C
GUERNSEY	76,691	5,298	784	78.2	10.8%
JERSEY	56,714	5,036	1,310	77.2	14.5%
BRITISH VIRGIN ISLANDS	19,746	6,811	3,825	72.4	28.1%
ISLE OF MAN	11,790	3,249	1,192	71.7	30.3%
GIBRALTAR	1,999	737	278	66.5	48.9%
HONG KONG	983	566	313	74.3	20.5%
CYPRUS	872	436	243	72.8	30.4%
PANAMA	735	375	278	66.5	48.2%
BAHAMAS	707	300	189	69.9	36.5%
SEYCHELLES	633	446	314	67.9	43.0%
CAYMAN ISLANDS	489	206	124	72.9	27.8%
BERMUDA	378	76	42	58.9	90.7%
BELIZE	295	158	86	73.5	27.1%
MAURITIUS	272	220	149	68.5	37.9%
LIECHTENSTEIN	239	136	75	63.0	54.8%

Notes: Properties in the tax-haven ownership group (IMF tax-haven jurisdiction lists applied to CCOD/OCOD country of incorporation), deduplicated by UPRN. Top 15 jurisdictions by property count. Share <C = share of properties below EPC band C (SAP < 69). Source: `universe_by_jurisdiction.csv` (script 08b).

3 Largest proprietors

Ownership is extraordinarily concentrated at the top, and the largest holders are all Channel Islands ground-rent freehold vehicles. The ten largest proprietors are led by Abacus Land 4 (Guernsey, 18,870 properties), Adriatic Land 3 (Guernsey, 14,490), Abacus Land 1 Holdco 1 (Jersey, 12,613) and Pennine Trustees (Jersey, 11,216), followed by a string of further Adriatic Land vehicles (numbers 11, 5, 12 and 9). These are freehold-reversion investment companies rather than occupier-landlords: they hold the ground rents beneath modern leasehold flats, which is why their portfolios are large, geographically dispersed (each spans hundreds of local authorities) and comparatively efficient (mean EPC 76 to 82, only 4 to 13 percent below band C). This is the opposite profile to the small opaque-haven holders, which own single prime or period units with poor efficiency. Portfolio size and low efficiency are therefore negatively, not positively, correlated in this universe: the biggest offshore landlords are ground-rent financiers, not the

Table 2: Largest Tax-Haven and Foreign Non-Profit Proprietors (Public Register)

Group	Proprietor (registered company)	Properties	LAs	Mean EPC	Share <C
Tax haven (all)	ABACUS LAND 4 LIMITED (GUERNSEY)	18,870	240	76.2	12.9%
Tax haven (all)	ADRIATIC LAND 3 LIMITED (GUERNSEY)	14,490	204	78.8	7.9%
Tax haven (all)	ABACUS LAND 1 (HOLDCO 1) LIMITED (JERSEY)	12,613	180	76.8	11.3%
Tax haven (all)	PENNINE TRUSTEES LIMITED (JERSEY)	11,216	48	79.2	6.4%
Tax haven (all)	ADRIATIC LAND 11 LIMITED (GUERNSEY)	8,544	152	78.7	9.3%
Tax haven (all)	ADRIATIC LAND 5 LIMITED (GUERNSEY)	6,625	112	78.9	12.3%
Tax haven (all)	ADRIATIC LAND 12 LIMITED (GUERNSEY)	3,624	54	82.2	3.6%
Tax haven (all)	ADRIATIC LAND 9 LIMITED (GUERNSEY)	3,189	72	81.6	3.5%
Tax haven (all)	ADRIATIC LAND 10 LIMITED (GUERNSEY)	3,038	53	81.9	8.3%
Tax haven (all)	ADRIATIC LAND 7 LIMITED (GUERNSEY)	2,825	78	80.9	5.0%
Foreign non-profit	THE DOLPHIN SQUARE ESTATE S.A.R.L. (LUXEMBOURG)	1,054	1	70.3	20.2%
Foreign non-profit	BALTIMORE WHARF SLP (JERSEY)	937	1	82.0	0.4%
Foreign non-profit	FREEHOLD REVERSIONS PARTNERSHIP INCORPORATED (GUERNSEY)	503	15	79.2	3.9%
Foreign non-profit	WHITEWOOD (RING) UK S.A.R.L. (LUXEMBOURG)	421	1	85.7	0.0%
Foreign non-profit	GREENGATE S.A R.L. (LUXEMBOURG)	351	1	82.6	0.3%

Notes: Proprietor names are registered company names from the public CCOD/OCOD registers (company-level data only; no individual beneficial owners). Properties = distinct UPRNs held under the (normalised) proprietor name. Source: `top_proprietors.csv` (script 08b).

worst-performing owners.

4 Outliers

The outlier table reports, per group, the five worst-EPC, largest-floor-area, highest-price, largest-portfolio-member and most-unusual-combination properties (75 rows). Implausible values (floor area under 10 or over 1,000 sqm, price under 1,000) are retained but flagged `data_quality_suspect` rather than presented as headline cases; the worst-EPC extremes in particular are dominated by nominal-price freehold-reversion transfers (a “price” of a few thousand pounds for a ground rent) and should not be read as market sales. The substantive outliers, super-prime central London units held through wealth havens with band F or G efficiency, are carried forward as the case studies below.

5 Case studies

Each proprietor below is a registered company; facts are drawn from the UK Register of Overseas Entities (ROE) and Companies House, and from reputable press or public planning records where cited. Consistent with the project’s disclosure rule, only company-level and public-register information is reported: no individual director, shareholder or beneficial-owner names appear. Register numbers are the ROE “OE” identifiers on the Companies House service. Where a source supports only a corporate-family link rather than the exact title-holding vehicle, that is said plainly.

5.1 Adriatic Land 3 (Guernsey): ground-rent freeholds

Adriatic Land 3 Limited (ROE 0E018380, incorporated in Guernsey, registered on the ROE on 26 January 2023) is one of the Channel Islands vehicles behind the largest offshore freehold holding in England and Wales. Our data attributes to it roughly 14,490 properties across 321 local authorities, with a good mean efficiency (EPC 79) characteristic of a freehold-reversion

owner of modern leasehold flats rather than an occupier-landlord. Reporting by Global Witness places the Adriatic Land and Abacus Land companies together at 2,926 freeholds, describes them as the country's largest offshore corporate freeholders, and links the group to the Long Harbour ground-rent investment fund.¹ In March 2022 Adriatic Land 3 Limited gave voluntary undertakings to the Competition and Markets Authority to remove doubling ground-rent clauses at a north London development, freeze ground rents at their commencement level, and meet leaseholders' costs.² A sibling entity, Abacus Land 4, illustrates the RPI-indexed model, its ground rent rising from £350 to £711 at first review.³ (The Guernsey ROE entity is distinct from the separately UK-incorporated "Adriatic Land 3 (GR1) Limited"; the specific Edgbaston freehold in our data is not among the published CMA cases.)

5.2 Vevil Properties (Jersey): the Curzon Mayfair estate

Vevil Properties Limited (ROE 0E013879, Jersey, registered 17 January 2023) belongs to the Vevil corporate family, reported to sit under Vevil International Ltd in the British Virgin Islands (where beneficial ownership is not publicly filed) with Jersey holding and operating subsidiaries.⁴ A 2016 marketing brochure listed the family's central London portfolio as including 38 Curzon Street, the site of the Curzon Mayfair cinema, alongside 160 Piccadilly (The Wolseley) and 27 Poultry (The Ned). The Curzon Mayfair (37–38 Curzon Street) is a Grade II listed 1960s building described by Historic England as the finest surviving post-war cinema, and it survived a 2016 closure threat after a public campaign. In our data the associated title carries a band-G efficiency (EPC 3), the extreme low end of the prime-central tail. The precise mapping of "Vevil Properties Limited" to the Curzon title, as opposed to a sibling Vevil vehicle, is not publicly confirmed.

5.3 Wildec Establishment (Liechtenstein): a Belgravia Anstalt

Wildec Establishment (ROE 0E004860) is a Liechtenstein *Anstalt*, a distinctive establishment entity with no exact UK analogue. Planning records of the Royal Borough of Kensington and Chelsea name Wildec Establishment as the client for alterations to 29 Wilton Crescent, a listed six-storey Belgravia house it purchased in 2018.⁵ The property appears in our data at £17.5m with a band-D efficiency.

5.4 AG Bloom LML 2 (Netherlands): an institutional joint-venture vehicle

AG Bloom LML 2 BV (ROE 0E002659, Netherlands, registered 28 October 2022) shares its naming, registered-office and control-correspondence pattern with the "AG Bloom" entities behind the Bloom / Angelo Gordon (now TPG Angelo Gordon) urban-logistics joint venture announced in December 2021, whose confirmed asset list includes a Camberwell scheme matching the SE5 address in our data.⁶ The link between this specific vehicle and 61 Lilford Road is inferred from the shared corporate signatures rather than a single filing; and because the venture is an "ultra-urban warehouse" programme, the residential EPC linkage in our data (£16m, band E) should

¹<https://www.globalwitness.org/en/campaigns/corruption-and-money-laundering/anonymous-company-owners/legalised-extortion/>

²<https://www.homegroundonline.com/news/2022/03/voluntary-undertakings-by-adriatic-land-3-limited-with-the-cma/>

³<https://www.leaseholdknowledge.com/abacus-land-sees-its-ground-rents-more-than-double-to-711-thanks-to-rpi/>

⁴<https://londoninbits.substack.com/p/the-curse-of-the-curzon>

⁵<https://docs.planning.org.uk/20211126/115/R2ZG25RPJ1S00/5r6xtq7rp5v29fcb.pdf>

⁶<https://www.thelogisticspoint.com/2021/12/13/bloom-and-angelo-gordon-announce-250mn-ultra-urban-warehouse-joint-venture/>

be read with caution, as it may reflect a mixed-use or ancillary residential element rather than a purely residential holding.

5.5 Privilege Oxford (Luxembourg): student accommodation

Privilege Oxford S.à r.l. (ROE 0E024676, Luxembourg, registered 8 February 2023) is the registered proprietor of the Slade Park student apartments in Headington, Oxford (£37m in our data), the single largest foreign-non-profit holding by value. Public reporting confirms an earlier ownership chain for the same Oxford Brookes scheme (a 2019 sale by Gatehouse Bank to a Scottish Widows property trust) but does not itself name Privilege Oxford, so the current title-to-vehicle step is consistent with, but not directly confirmed by, the public record.

5.6 Athena Healthcare (Much Hoole) (Isle of Man): a care home

The proprietor recorded in our data, Athena Healthcare (Much Hoole) Limited (Isle of Man, UK establishment FC036769, nature of business “operation of residential care home”), was renamed Sandstone Care (Much Hoole) Limited on 20 April 2021; the wider Athena Healthcare Group continues as a separate ongoing operator.⁷ The home, a residential and nursing home near Preston, shows that the offshore-incorporation universe is not solely prime-residential: operational care assets are held through the same Crown Dependency structures. (Our register cross-section predates the rename, hence the Athena name; the site is branded “Ribble Court” by the current operator.)

5.7 Register-only cases

For four of the shortlisted proprietors only the bare incorporation could be verified, and no company-level public reporting was located: MRF Managing Trustee No. 1 Limited (Jersey, 0E007919; the “Managing Trustee” form is consistent with a Jersey Property Unit Trust structure), Balea Stiftung (Liechtenstein foundation, 0E017732), Caerus Limited (Jersey, 0E030686) and Ripley Ventures SA (British Virgin Islands, 0E013441, administered through a BVI registered agent). That the register yields an address, a jurisdiction and nothing more is itself the point: for a large share of the offshore universe the public record stops at the incorporation certificate, which is precisely the transparency gap that a beneficial-ownership layer (future work) would close.

6 Caveats and future work

The ownership cross-section is the January 2025 register, so profiles are survivorship-conditioned; `date_proprietor_added` reflects the current owner’s registration, not acquisition of the portfolio. Jurisdiction here is the country of *legal incorporation* of the registered proprietor. A beneficial-ownership layer (PSC and Register of Overseas Entities linkage, as built for the London project) would separate offshore incorporation from offshore control and is left as future work for this branch.

⁷<https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/FC036769>